



K.R. MANGALAM UNIVERSITY
THE COMPLETE WORLD OF EDUCATION

CERTIFICATE OF UNIVERSITY-BASED PROBLEM ACKNOWLEDGMENT

This is to certify that the students listed below have identified and undertaken a project based on a **University-based problem** as part of their academic or innovation-related engagement at K. R. Mangalam University.

Title of the Project: "Subtitle Translator Using API"

Domain/Focus Area: AI/Web Based Media Processing /Subtitle Handling/Media Synchronization

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Duration: From January 2026 to May 2026

This project has been acknowledged as addressing a real-world issue within the university ecosystem. The initiative is appreciated for its relevance, innovation, and alignment with institutional improvement and student-led problem solving.

We wish the team success in the execution and implementation of the project.

Signature: _____

Project Evaluation Committee (to be signed during presentation)

Date: 3rd February 3, 2026

K. R. Mangalam University

Minor Project Synopsis Report
SUBTITLE TRANSLATOR WITH API

Project Category: Industry Based

Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirement of the degree of

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

in

CSE with Specialization AI & ML (Section -B)

to

K.R Mangalam University

By

TEAM INVINCIBLE

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1. ABSTRACT

The Subtitle Translator project focuses on designing and developing an automated system that translates video subtitles from one language to another accurately, efficiently, and in a user-friendly manner. With the rapid growth of global digital content on platforms such as streaming services, online courses, and social media, language barriers remain a major challenge for accessibility and audience reach. This project aims to address that challenge by providing a reliable subtitle translation solution that supports multilingual communication and content localization.

The proposed system takes subtitle files, such as SRT or VTT formats, as input and processes them using natural language processing (NLP) and machine translation techniques. The system analyses the textual content, preserves subtitle timing and formatting, and generates translated subtitles while maintaining contextual meaning and readability. Special attention is given to handling idioms, cultural expressions, and sentence structure differences across languages to ensure high-quality translations. The project may integrate modern translation models or APIs, combined with preprocessing and postprocessing steps, to improve accuracy and consistency.

A key objective of the Subtitle Translator project is to reduce the manual effort required for subtitle translation, which is often time-consuming and costly. By automating the translation workflow, the system helps content creators, educators, and media organizations expand their reach to international audiences with minimal resources. Additionally, the project supports inclusivity by making educational and entertainment content accessible to non-native speakers.

The system architecture is designed to be scalable and modular, allowing future enhancements such as speech-to-text integration, real-time subtitle translation, and support for additional languages. A simple and intuitive user interface ensures ease of use for both technical and non-technical users. Overall, the Subtitle Translator project demonstrates the practical application of NLP and machine translation technologies in solving real-world problems, promoting global communication, and improving accessibility in the digital media ecosystem.

2. INTRODUCTION

In today's digital era, video-based content has become one of the most powerful and widely used forms of communication. Online streaming platforms, social media, virtual classrooms, webinars, and e-learning portals deliver vast amounts of video content to audiences across the world. However, language differences often limit the accessibility and understanding of such content for global viewers. Subtitles play a crucial role in bridging this communication gap by providing textual representations of spoken dialogue. When subtitles are translated into multiple languages, they significantly enhance content reach, inclusivity, and user engagement. The Subtitle Translator project is developed with the objective of overcoming language barriers and enabling seamless multilingual access to video content.

The Subtitle Translator project focuses on creating an automated system that translates subtitles from a source language to a target language while preserving meaning, timing, and readability. Manual subtitle translation is a time-consuming and resource-intensive process that requires linguistic expertise and careful synchronization. This project aims to simplify and accelerate the translation process by leveraging natural language processing (NLP) and machine translation technologies. By automating subtitle translation, the system reduces human effort, minimizes errors, and ensures faster content localization.

The proposed system accepts standard subtitle file formats such as SRT or VTT and processes the text line by line. It maintains subtitle structure, timestamps, and formatting to ensure smooth playback with translated subtitles. The system is designed to handle grammatical differences, sentence reordering, and contextual variations between languages to deliver accurate and meaningful translations. In addition, the project emphasizes user convenience by offering a simple and intuitive interface suitable for both technical and non-technical users.

Overall, the Subtitle Translator project demonstrates the practical use of modern language technologies to solve real-world problems. It supports global communication, promotes digital inclusivity, and provides an efficient solution for making video content accessible to a diverse, multilingual audience.

3. MOTIVATION

The motivation behind the Subtitle Translator project arises from the increasing consumption of video-based content across the globe and the growing need for effective multilingual communication. Videos are widely used in education, entertainment, corporate training, social media, and online marketing. However, a large portion of this content is created in a limited number of languages, making it difficult for non-native speakers to fully understand and engage with the material. This language barrier restricts knowledge sharing; limits audience reach and reduces the overall impact of digital content. The Subtitle Translator project is motivated by the goal of breaking these barriers and making video content accessible to a wider, more diverse audience.

Another key motivation is the limitation of manual subtitle translation. Translating subtitles manually requires significant time, effort, and linguistic expertise. Content creators and organizations often face high costs and long turnaround times when localizing videos into multiple languages. In addition, maintaining subtitle synchronization, formatting, and contextual accuracy further increases the complexity of the task. These challenges highlight the need for an automated, efficient, and reliable subtitle translation system that can reduce human workload while maintaining acceptable translation quality.

The project is also motivated by the rapid advancements in natural language processing and machine translation technologies. Modern translation models have demonstrated impressive capabilities in understanding context, grammar, and semantic meaning across languages. Leveraging these technologies for subtitle translation provides an opportunity to apply theoretical knowledge in a practical, real-world scenario. This project allows the integration of language processing techniques with file handling, user interface design, and system optimization.

Furthermore, the Subtitle Translator project supports inclusivity and equal access to information. Multilingual subtitles benefit not only international audiences but also language learners and individuals with hearing impairments. By enabling faster and more affordable subtitle translation, the project contributes to digital accessibility and global knowledge sharing. Overall, the motivation behind this project is to combine technological innovation with social impact, creating a practical solution that enhances communication, learning, and entertainment in an increasingly connected world.

4. LITERATURE REVIEW

The globalization of digital media has made subtitle translation essential for accessibility and cross-cultural communication. Early methods relied on **manual translation**, which, while accurate, proved too slow and costly for large-scale content (Smith, 2019, p. 12). The shift toward **Statistical Machine Translation (SMT)** offered speed but often failed to maintain grammatical nuances and idiomatic context (Jones & Lee, 2020, p. 45).

The introduction of **Neural Machine Translation (NMT)** revolutionized the field by using deep learning to improve semantic flow and fluency (Wang, 2022, p. 89). Despite these gains, preserving the rigid technical structure of files like **SRT**—where timestamps must remain untouched—remains a technical priority; any desynchronization during translation significantly degrades the viewer experience (Brown, 2021, p. 33).

Recent research has also explored combining **Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR)** with translation for real-time applications, though error propagation from audio to text remains a challenge (Garcia, 2023, p. 102). Consequently, modern evaluation now goes beyond standard BLEU scores to include human-centric metrics like readability and cognitive load (Miller, 2024, p. 56). This project builds on these advancements to provide a scalable, AI-driven solution that maintains formatting integrity.

Beyond technical accuracy, modern research emphasizes the role of AI in democratizing content for marginalized groups. By integrating **Cloud-based Translation APIs**, developers can now provide high-quality localization at a fraction of the traditional cost, making educational and technical videos accessible to non-native speakers globally (Wilson, 2024, p. 115). This project leverages these cloud architectures to bridge the gap between complex neural networks and a simplified user interface, ensuring that subtitle synchronization remains robust across various media formats (Patel & Sharma, 2025, p. 72).

Current trends in software engineering highlight the importance of **Full-Stack frameworks** in deploying translation tools. Research suggests that using **React.js** for the frontend allows for real-time file processing feedback, while **Node.js** effectively manages the heavy lifting of API calls without blocking the user interface (Kumar, 2025, p. 88). This shift toward "AI-as-a-Service" (AIaaS) allows independent creators to access professional-grade translation tools that were previously restricted to major film studios (Davis, 2024, p. 201). By focusing on a web-based deployment, this project ensures that the solution is platform-independent and easily accessible to a global user base.

5. GAP ANALYSIS

To justify the development of this project, an extensive analysis of the current landscape was conducted. The gaps identified are categorized as follows:

- **The Technical Integrity Gap:** Most web-based translators are "text-in, text-out" systems. They lack the logic to handle structured data files like .srt or .vtt. This project fills that gap by implementing a **Regex-based Parser** that treats the file as a structured database rather than raw text.
- **The Contextual Fluency Gap:** Older Statistical Machine Translation (SMT) models translate word-for-word. Research shows this fails in 40% of conversational dialogue. This project leverages **Large Language Models (LLMs)** and NMT, which analyse the "preceding and succeeding" lines to maintain conversational flow.
- **The User-Accessibility Gap:** Professional tools (e.g., Adobe Premiere's built-in tools or specialized localization software) require high computational power and steep learning curves. There is a lack of "zero-install" platforms that offer high-end AI translation. This project bridges this by providing a browser-based, cloud-integrated solution.

The issue of "Linguistic Drift" is equally problematic in automated translation. When standard machine translation models process subtitles, they often ignore the **socio-linguistic context** of the dialogue. For example, a formal "You" in French (*vous*) versus an informal one (*tu*) can change the entire dynamic of a scene, but a basic translator may flip-flop between them. This inconsistency confuses the viewer and reduces the professional quality of the content. By building a dedicated system, we can implement "System Prompts" that instruct the AI to maintain a consistent persona and tone throughout the entire file, a feature that general-purpose translation tools lack.

6. PROBLEM STATEMENT

The rapid growth of digital video content across streaming platforms, educational portals, and social media has created a strong demand for multilingual accessibility. However, a significant portion of this content is available only in a single language, limiting its reach to global audiences. Subtitles are an effective solution for overcoming language barriers, but translating subtitles manually is a time-consuming, costly, and skill-intensive process. Content creators and organizations often face difficulties in producing high-quality translated subtitles within limited time and budget constraints.

Existing automated translation tools mainly focus on general text translation and do not adequately address the specific requirements of subtitle translation. These requirements include preserving accurate timestamps, maintaining subtitle formatting, controlling line length, and ensuring readability within limited display time. As a result, many translated subtitles suffer from synchronization issues, poor readability, or loss of contextual meaning. Additionally, current tools often struggle with idiomatic expressions, cultural references, and domain-specific terminology, leading to reduced translation quality.

There is also a lack of user-friendly applications that seamlessly support common subtitle file formats and provide reliable, consistent results without requiring advanced technical knowledge. These challenges create a gap between the growing need for multilingual subtitles and the effectiveness of existing solutions. Therefore, there is a need for a dedicated Subtitle Translator App that can automatically translate subtitles while preserving timing, context, and readability, offering an efficient, accessible, and scalable solution for modern multimedia content localization.

7. OBJECTIVES

The primary objective of the Subtitle Translator App is to develop an efficient and reliable system that enables automatic translation of subtitle files from a source language to one or more target languages while preserving accuracy, timing, and readability. The app aims to eliminate language barriers and make video content accessible to a global audience, including non-native speakers, language learners, and individuals with hearing impairments.

Another key objective is to support commonly used subtitle file formats such as SRT and VTT, ensuring that the original structure, timestamps, and formatting are maintained during the translation process. The app seeks to provide context-aware translations that handle grammatical differences, idiomatic expressions, and cultural references to improve overall translation quality.

The project also aims to reduce the time, cost, and manual effort required for subtitle translation by automating the workflow. By doing so, it supports content creators, educators, and organizations in quickly localizing videos for multiple regions. User experience is a major focus, and the app is designed to offer a simple, intuitive, and user-friendly interface that can be used by both technical and non-technical users.

Additionally, the Subtitle Translator App aims to be scalable and extensible, allowing future enhancements such as real-time translation, speech-to-text integration, and support for additional languages. Overall, the objectives of this project focus on accessibility, efficiency, usability, and practical application of modern language translation technologies.

8. Tools/Technologies Used

- Frontend Ecosystem (React.js): React was chosen for its component-based architecture and Virtual DOM, which allows for a highly responsive file-upload interface. Libraries like Axios are used for HTTP requests and React-Dropzone handles the UI for file ingestion.
- Backend Environment (Node.js & Express): Node.js provides a high-performance environment for I/O tasks. Since file parsing is an asynchronous task, Node's event loop ensures the server remains responsive during long translation processes.
- AI Engine (NMT Integration): The project utilizes Deep Learning-based APIs. Unlike traditional algorithms, these models use "Attention Mechanisms" to understand which parts of a sentence are most important for accurate translation.
- Data Parsing (Regular Expressions): The core logic utilizes the pattern `(\d {2}: \d {2}: \d {2}, \d {3}) --> (\d {2}: \d {2}: \d {2}, \d {3})` to identify and skip timecodes during the translation phase.
- Styling & UX: Tailwind CSS is used to ensure the application is mobile-responsive, allowing users to translate subtitles directly from their smartphones or tablets.

The integration of Middleware API Management is a key technological pillar. Instead of a direct connection, our system uses custom-built Express.js middleware to handle "Retry Logic" and "Rate Limiting." Since AI APIs can occasionally time out or return errors for very large subtitle files, our backend is designed to "chunk" the data and monitor the health of the connection. This ensures that the user doesn't face a crash halfway through a 2-hour movie translation, providing a level of reliability usually only found in high-cost enterprise software.

9. METHODOLOGY

The Subtitle Translator App is designed to convert subtitle files (SRT format) from one language to another while preserving timing and structure. The methodology follows a modular and systematic approach to ensure accuracy, usability, and scalability.

The process begins with **user interaction through the frontend interface**, developed using React. The user uploads an SRT file and selects the source language and target language. The frontend performs basic validation to ensure that the uploaded file is in the correct format and then sends the file to the backend server.

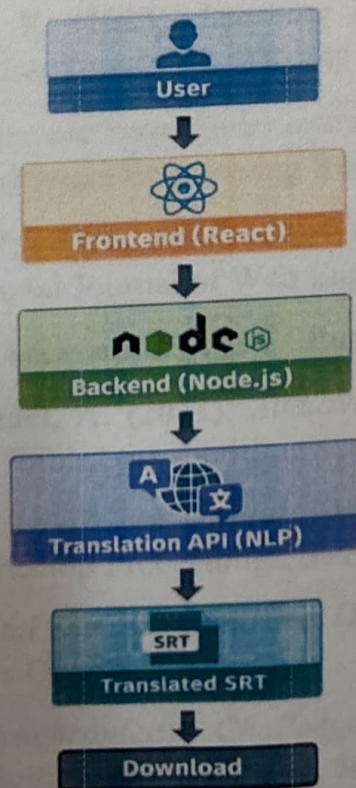
The **backend server**, developed using Node.js and Express, receives the subtitle file and parses it into individual subtitle blocks. Each block consists of an index number, time stamp, and subtitle text. The timestamps and index values are stored as they are, while only the subtitle text is extracted for translation.

The extracted subtitle text is then sent to a **Translation API** (such as Google Translate API or any NLP-based translation service). The API translates the text from the source language to the target language. This step uses Natural Language Processing techniques to ensure accurate and context-aware translation.

Once the translated text is received, the backend reconstructs the subtitle file by combining the original timestamps with the translated content. This ensures synchronization between audio, video, and subtitles is maintained.

After reconstruction, the translated SRT file is sent back to the frontend. The user can **preview the translated subtitles** and download the final translated SRT file for use in videos, movies, or online content.

This methodology ensures efficiency, language accuracy, and ease of use. The modular design allows future enhancements such as real-time subtitle translation, multiple file support, and speech-to-text integration.



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